

Daily Bible Note

Date: July 16, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 25:1-11

1 The word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 "Son of man, set your face against the Ammonites, and prophesy against them.

3 Say to the Ammonites, 'Hear the word of the Lord God! Thus says the Lord God: "Because you said, 'Aha!' against My sanctuary when it was profaned, and against the land of Israel when it was desolate, and against the house of Judah when they went into captivity,

4 indeed, therefore, I will deliver you as a possession to the men of the East, and they shall set their encampments among you and make their dwellings among you; they shall eat your fruit, and they shall drink your milk.

5 And I will make Rabbah a stable for camels and Ammon a resting place for flocks. Then you shall know that I am the Lord."

6 'For thus says the Lord God: "Because you clapped your hands, stamped your feet, and rejoiced in heart with all your disdain for the land of Israel,

7 indeed, therefore, I will stretch out My hand against you, and give you as plunder to the nations; I will cut you off from the peoples, and I will cause you to perish from the countries; I will destroy you, and you shall know that I am the Lord."

8 'Thus says the Lord God: "Because Moab and Seir say, 'Look! The house of Judah is like all the nations,'

9 therefore, behold, I will clear the territory of Moab of cities, of the cities on its frontier, the glory of the country, Beth Jeshimoth, Baal Meon, and Kirjathaim.

10 To the men of the East I will give it as a possession, together with the Ammonites, that the Ammonites may not be remembered among the nations.

11 And I will execute judgments upon Moab, and they shall know that I am the Lord."

II. Key Summary

- God tells Ezekiel to set his face against the Ammonites, pointing out that when the sanctuary was profaned, the land of Israel left desolate, and Judah taken captive, the Ammonites said, "Aha!"
 - God also names how the Ammonites clapped their hands, stamped their feet, and rejoiced with disdain against Israel, so He declares He will stretch out His hand, hand them over to the nations, and cut them off from the peoples.
 - God brings the same judgment on Moab and Seir for saying "the house of Judah is like all the nations," and repeatedly states the result: "they shall know that I am the Lord."
-

III. Passage Analysis

Being glad at someone else's disaster is itself a sin

It is wicked to be glad at the calamities of any, especially of God's people; it is a sin for which he will surely reckon. [1]

The Ammonites never laid a hand on Judah—they just stood by and said, "Aha!" Yet God took it seriously. The passage tells us that the quiet thrill of enjoying someone's downfall is no small thing in God's eyes.

God has not forgotten His mistreated people

Even when unbelievers look down on and mistreat God's people, God will surely watch over them and in the end will take away all their shame. [2]

Judah looked wrecked and humiliated at that moment, as if God had abandoned them. But this passage is actually speaking to those who are suffering: God sees it all, and He will not let His people be trampled forever.

IV. Reflection Question

When someone you don't really like—maybe a classmate you've clashed with—messes up, gets called out, or bombs a test, does a quiet "serves them right" ever sneak up in your heart?

The Ammonites were held accountable for saying just one "Aha!" over someone else's disaster; God cares not only about what you do, but about the very first thought that rises in you when someone else falls.

References

[1] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry Commentary on Ezekiel 25,
https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/eze/eze_025.cfm

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study (ccbiblestudy.org), Ezekiel Chapter 25 Notes (Grace Bible Study Reader), <https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT25.htm>